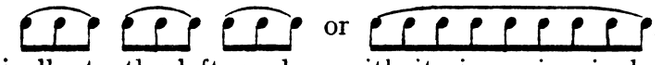
PRELUDE XX

THE *tempo* is fairly lively, and the touch may be varied within such limits as exclude hardness and dryness. The occasional homophonic chords may be slightly broken (especially where, as in bars 9, 10, and 11, the bottom note ends a phrase), and they should be regarded as elements of luxury in the otherwise strict two-part economy. The most luxurious harmonic effect is that of sustained chords left behind by a run (bars 16, 18), and the pianoforte produces it successfully only when the tone throughout the whole piece is entirely unforced.

Many varieties of phrasing with melodiously detached and slurred quavers are permissible, so long as they stand the test of occurring spontaneously to the voice in singing. Avoid the dull uniform phrasing of all three groups in the bar as  . A mere *legato* would be better than that.

The repeated quavers in the bass of bars 17 and 19 should not be drummed, but should be of the nature of the clavichord *Bebung*  . In bar 4 the right hand should join melodically to the left, and so with its inversion in bar 8. Obviously this also applies to bars 16 and 18.

FUGUE XX

THIS is probably written for a harpsichord with pedals, though Bach may have had the last eight bars assisted by a third hand. The plan of the whole is like an early adumbration (probably earlier than anything else in the Forty-eight) of the scheme worked out years later with perfect economy and maturity on more beautiful material in the great B♭ minor Fugue in Book II.

The *tempo* should not be too slow, or the harmonies (and the melody of the Inverted Subject) will sound harsh, and the tone required for building up such long processes to their climax will become forced. On the other hand, a lively reading with chopped-up phrasing produces more harshness of harmony than too slow a reading, and also loses dignity without achieving humour. The right *tempo* will flow evenly at such a pace that bar 17 (with the bracketed shake) and bars 40-41 sound graceful. (All bracketed shakes should be played; there is doubt as to whether Bach wrote them here, but none whatever as to his intending them.)

The only exceptions to the general *legato* so necessary for smoothing the harmony are, first, the pair of quavers (G♯, E) in the Subject following the downward seventh. If these are slightly detached, their inversion in the Inverted Subject will sound much more intelligible, and bar 69 will cease to be unplayable. Secondly, unthematic quavers in the bass (*i.e.*, basses not traceable to the important scale-figure of the Countersubject) should be lightly detached.

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Full source scan

In the exposition the Countersubject is as important as the Subject, but is more important in bars 4 and 6 where its material is new, than in bar 5 where it develops a figure of the Subject. Such imitations produce their cumulative effect without requiring any emphasis, and throughout this Fugue it is particularly important that incidental figure-work should not mask real entries and real Stretti. On the other hand, wherever such figures produce any noticeable doubling of parts in thirds or sixths, the full harmonic value thereof should be brought out (*e.g.*, bars 11-12); and the scale-figure of the Countersubject, both direct (as a descent) and inverted (as an ascent), should always have its value both in harmony and (as in bars 15-16) in antiphonal dialogue. The plan of the Fugue, which is not without redundancies, is as follows: Exposition of Subject (with Countersubject) in four parts (Alto, Treble, Bass, Tenor), bars 1-14. (Mark the interesting C♯ in the bass at bar 10.) Exposition of Inverted Subject in various keys in all four parts (Soprano, A minor to G major; Tenor, C major to D minor—be careful not to mask its entry by the anticipation in the Alto—Bass, D minor to C major; Alto, A minor), bars 14½-27. First Stretto in the octave at half a bar, Soprano and Tenor (A minor), followed by the same Stretto in E minor between Alto and Bass, bars 27½-34. It is given again (led by the lower part) between Tenor and Alto (A minor) in bars 36½-40, and, lastly, in C major between Soprano and Bass, bars 43-47. In bar 48 the extra entry of the inverted first figure in the Soprano masks the entry of the Second Stretto, which applies the method of the First Stretto to the Inverted Subject: Alto and Tenor (D minor to C) in bars 48½-52; Bass and Soprano (G major) in bars 53-56; and, a third time, leading to a climax in Soprano and Alto (A minor), bars 57½-60. One more fragment of it between Tenor and Bass leads to a close in D minor, from which arises the Third Stretto, followed by its inversion, the Fourth Stretto. These are derived from the others by the fact that all are designed in double counterpoint in the twelfth, so that a Stretto in the lower octave converts into one in the upper fifth. Accordingly, bars 64½-67 give it direct between Bass and Tenor in the upper fifth, overlapping in bar 67 with the Inverted Stretto between Soprano and Alto in the lower fifth. In bars 73-75, the old Inverted Stretto reappears in F major between Bass and Alto, leading to the Fifth Stretto, bars 76-78, which (dealing only with the first phrase) answers the Inverted Subject in the Tenor by the Direct Subject at a whole bar's distance in the Alto, and caps it by an additional imitation (here to be given due rhetorical force) in the Soprano.

If Bach used a pedal-board or a third hand (playing, of course, "with 16-foot tone" —*i.e.*, adding a lower octave) in this Fugue, it entered not merely on the final organ-point, but already as the bass of the chords beginning with the pause. The notes here added in small print thus represent not a pianoforte modernisation, but the actual facts of the case. The player can use either a score-reader's *arpeggio*-skips (as indicated in bracketed grace-notes in the last three bars) or get a friend to lend a third hand.

In this Coda (from bar 80) every allusion to the Subject must be emphasised so as to produce the outward effect of four-part Stretti by way of climax.